INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MADRAS

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Ref. No.: IITM/CSE/ACAD/2026/23 Date: 09 September 2026

NOTICE

ACADEMIC PREPARATION REQUIREMENTS FOR SECOND-YEAR STUDENTS – SEMESTER III

All students entering the **Second Year of the B.Tech. programme** are hereby informed that, owing to the revised academic schedule and the consequent reduction in the effective preparation period available before the commencement of Semester III, certain preparatory requirements have been prescribed for the Semester III curriculum.

Students are required to take note of the following course-wise arrangements.

A. SEMESTER III COURSES

The Semester III academic programme comprises the following courses:

Course Code	Course Title
CS2700	Programming and Data Structures
CS2710	Programming and Data Structures Laboratory
CS2300	Foundations of Computer Systems Design
CS2310	Foundations of Computer Systems Design Laboratory
MA2103	Probability, Stochastic Processes and Statistics
HSE1	Humanities Elective 1
MSX026	Entrepreneurship

B. COURSES REQUIRING PRIOR SELF-STUDY

In view of the limited academic preparation period, students shall undertake self-study **only for the following courses prior to the commencement of the corresponding regular instruction:**

1. **CS2700 – Programming and Data Structures**
2. **CS2300 – Foundations of Computer Systems Design**

The Institute shall provide the prescribed learning resources and reference material for the above courses through the designated academic channels.

Students are advised to complete the relevant preparatory material before the commencement of the regular coursework. The purpose of this requirement is to ensure that students possess the necessary programming fundamentals for the subsequent classroom and laboratory instruction.

C. USE OF EXTERNAL ACADEMIC RESOURCES

Students may supplement the Institute-provided material with resources available from recognized third-party educational platforms, instructors, books, courses, or other academic sources.

However, such resources should be used **only as supplementary material** and should correspond substantially to the concepts, topics, programming fundamentals, and learning objectives covered in the material prescribed or provided by the Institute.

Students shall remain responsible for completing the academic material specifically prescribed by IIT Madras.

D. RECOMMENDED FOUNDATIONAL COURSE – CS50x

Students are **strongly encouraged** to complete **CS50x – Introduction to Computer Science**, offered by Harvard University, as supplementary foundational preparation.

The course is recommended particularly for students who require additional preparation in programming and fundamental computer-science concepts before commencing Programming and Data Structures.

Students who have already completed CS50x **need not undertake the course again**.

Students who have previously completed the course are advised to retain evidence of completion. Where specifically requested by the Institute for academic verification or reference, such students may be required to provide the relevant **GitHub repository address and associated GitHub account details**.

E. OTHER SEMESTER III COURSES

No independent completion of the syllabus prior to regular instruction is prescribed under this notice for:

- **CS2710 – Programming and Data Structures Laboratory**
- **CS2310 – Foundations of Computer Systems Design Laboratory**
- **MA2103 – Probability, Stochastic Processes and Statistics**
- **HSE1 – Humanities Elective 1**
- **MSXXXX – Entrepreneurship**

The academic instruction, learning resources, laboratory activities, assignments, assessments, and other requirements relating to these courses shall be communicated separately through the concerned academic and departmental channels.

F. IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS

Students are advised to commence the prescribed preparation immediately and to make effective use of the academic resources provided by the Institute.

The self-study arrangement specified in this notice is an **academic preparatory measure necessitated by the revised academic calendar** and shall not be construed as a replacement for the regular instruction, laboratory work, assessments, or other academic requirements prescribed for Semester III.

Further course-specific instructions, including the detailed syllabus coverage and academic resources, shall be communicated separately wherever applicable.

All students are directed to follow only the latest instructions issued through the **official IIT Madras academic and departmental communication channels**.

By Order of the Head of the Department

Department of Computer Science and Engineering
Indian Institute of Technology Madras
Chennai – 600036

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